MONTHLY UPDATE

Digital Payments and Fintech: monthly update, August 2026

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37 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

Algeria

The payments layer gained a governing body and a small number. A central bank regulation established a National Payments Committee, and the count of web merchants accepting electronic payment passed 1,000 at the end of June. A thousand merchants is a small number for a market this size, and it is the first such count the base holds, so the level is stated and the direction is not.

Botswana

The month's three payments developments are all commercial and narrow. A commercial bank and the Yellow Light Taxi Association launched card acceptance on the bank's mobile tap product for taxi operators in Gaborone on 9 August, with access to business loans of up to P60,000 conditioned on the formal banking history the operators build through it. It is one bank and one association; no operator count, uptake figure or fee schedule is stated, and the credit on offer is tied to banking with the institution providing the terminal. Nine days later a remittance operator issued a card on its wallet through a commercial bank and an international scheme, adding ATM withdrawal, in-store payment and domestic online purchase to a wallet that carried transfer and cash-out only. The operator's own account of the Companion Card puts the point of it plainly: no separate bank account is required and the card works across every mobile network in the country, against an estimated 38 per cent of adults unbanked. Here too there is no customer count, issuance volume or fee schedule on the record. A commercial bank and an international card scheme then opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Botswana on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Botswana. The national payment switch and the citizen wallet both remain at Planned.

Burkina Faso

The regional instant-payment rail moved its deadlines rather than its coverage: the central bank extended connection to 30 September 2026 for banks and payment institutions and 30 June 2027 for microfinance, with 80 institutions connected union-wide at 24 June and 74 more in test.

Burundi

Three payment rails moved. The national instant payment system, launched publicly in April, had 17 of 78 licensed institutions live by 4 August, five commercial banks and ten microfinance institutions among them. The central bank acceded to the pan-African payment and settlement system, with four domestic banks authorised to participate, and told the regional governors it expects to join the East African cross-border payment network by December 2026.

At the counter, none of that reaches the constraint. Traders at Karusi report that electronic invoicing machines stop with every power cut, which is the same limit the regulator names for network quality.

Cameroon

Payments had the month's densest run. On 9 July the regional central bank joined the pan-African settlement system, extending it to all six member states and 72m people, with member-state banks to be integrated by end-2026; no Cameroonian bank is yet named as live on it. On 29 July an interoperable QR-code standard launched under a regional regulation of 8 April, letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six states. A day later a consultation opened on revising the switch's tariff grid, the operator conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments; no revised grid or effective date is published.

The continental rail reached the monetary union without reaching its businesses. The central bank joined the pan-African payment and settlement system on 9 July, which an analysis of the trade minister's 21 August call to business describes as the necessary monetary and regulatory piece and not one that opens the service to customers: commercial banks, fintechs and payment providers must still connect technically and switch on the channels that initiate transactions. The operator's coverage claims - 28 countries, more than 190 banks and fintechs, 16 switches - establish reachability rather than that any institution here can yet send and receive.

A domestic entrant arrived on 31 August. A Cameroonian technology company launched a payments platform carrying transfers across mobile-money networks, wallet management, bill and airtime payment, payment links and developer interfaces, opening here with a stated ambition to reach other African markets. It is a launch announcement on the company's own account: no user, merchant or transaction figure, licence or partner bank is named.

Central African Republic

Electricity bills became payable over mobile money at a Bangui launch on 4 August, under a contract dated October 2025, a partnership between a mobile operator and the state electricity utility. No tariff, coverage figure or transaction volume is published, and the ten months between contract and launch is the only measure the base holds of what such a build takes in time here.

Chad

On 24 July the Ministry of Finance took delivery of 3,000 smart electronic payment terminals supplied under the World Bank-financed Projet d'appui à la transformation numérique, intended to digitise collection of public revenue; the ministry named no deployment schedule, target sites or per-agency allocation.

The 2027 budget orientations, reported 4 August, restate the mandate for exclusive electronic payment of state obligations — bank or mobile transfer only, against a standardised electronic invoice — for a start of 1 January 2027. The same regime had already been mandated for budget year 2026 — exclusively bank or mobile payments, cash and cheques out; nothing in the base shows that 2026 mandate operating, so the restatement is a year's slip rather than a new commitment. Chad had already launched the standardised electronic invoice itself, among the first CEMAC states to do so, under the 2026 budget; the August orientations move only the exclusivity date.

On 29 July, at Douala, the BEAC and GIMAC launched the CEMAC's interoperable QR-code payment standard, in force under a monetary-union regulation of 8 April 2026 across all six member states including Chad and letting any bank, mobile-money or microfinance account settle a purchase at any merchant's code, routed and settled through the regional switch. No Chadian bank, wallet or merchant deployment is on record: Chad is covered by the regulation rather than shown live.

Comoros

A fault between the mobile-money service and the utility's prepaid electricity meters on Moheli let subscribers credit their meters without the amounts being collected, with presumed losses of 200 million francs. The figure is presumed in the reporting rather than confirmed by either party, and no remediation, recovery or audit has followed.

Congo

On 3 August the public-revenue platform went live on the national payments switch, payment following a declaration, authenticated, reconciled in real time and routed to the treasury against a secured electronic receipt. Roll-out runs at large then medium enterprises, all taxpayers targeted by end-2026 and no wave dates published. The same account records the treasury single account at the regional central bank still being finalised.

Cote d'Ivoire

A private schools federation signed a convention on 21 July putting fee collection onto mobile money in a 200-school pilot from August. The flat FCFA 100 agency fee levied on every mobile-money counter transaction since November 2025 was documented on 24 July as authorised by no operator tariff and no regulator, regressive by construction on small transfers.

Egypt

Two things moved on the payment rails. The instant payment network began crediting inbound cross-border remittances instantly at all banks operating in Egypt. And factoring, where the platform now vets invoices before financing to enforce the ban on double-funding a receivable, against factored paper up 77.8% in 2025 to EGP 132.2bn.

The operator that builds the state's payment infrastructure also became a lender. On 13 August it agreed the full acquisition of an Egyptian non-bank lender to small and medium firms, extending its own infrastructure into direct lending. No consideration is disclosed in the records held, and neither states any separation between running government payment rails and holding a lending book that runs on them.

Eswatini

The mobile money platform moved underneath its users. An operator completed migration of its money platform to a cloud-native vendor platform across four African markets, this one among them. No downtime, subscriber count or feature change is stated for the Eswatini market, so the base holds that the rail changed hands technically and nothing about what that cost its users.

Ethiopia

Payments extended into utilities and tax. Prepaid electricity purchase entered the mobile-money super app on 29 July for smart-meter customers, and a digital tax-payment service for one regional revenue bureau launched on 28 July as the first of a planned series.

The market also drew a new foreign supplier. A South African financial-technology firm entered the Ethiopian payments market with a local engineering partner on 17 August, aligning onboarding, fraud-management and workflow-automation tools with the National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030. No commitment value, customer or deployment date is disclosed.

Federal authorities began testing whether a single payment window can serve the whole government, starting with health. No transaction volume, participating-institution list or rollout timetable accompanies the pilot.

Gambia

The country appears here in a survey of other people's pilots rather than in an account of its own. A UN development agency names a wallet pilot in the Gambia among blockchain-based payment-distribution schemes said to cut distribution costs from about 10% to as little as 2%. The cost figure is the agency's own and describes its portfolio rather than this pilot; no caseload, value distributed or evaluation is held for the Gambian instance.

Ghana

Central bank data for June 2026 put mobile money at 954 million transactions worth GH¢492.9bn, against GH¢323.2bn a year earlier, on 84.6 million registered wallets of which 26.4 million were active; interoperable transfers were GH¢6.2bn, about 1.3% of value.

Enforcement of the digital-credit regime opened. A notice of 20 July recorded the 30 June licensing deadline as elapsed, and a notice of 3 August named twenty unlicensed lending applications, cautioning banks and payment providers against processing for them and framing the harm first as a violation of customer data privacy. The promised register of licensed providers remains unpublished.

The dominant operator opened a channel to the next cohort of providers instead. A three-month fintech accelerator launched on 12 August across Accra, Kumasi and Tamale, with a domestic technology firm as its official technology partner. No cohort size, selection criteria, funding or equity terms are stated.

Card acceptance widened from outside the domestic rails. A commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Ghana on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Ghana.

Guinea

NimbaPay opened for operations on 22 July 2026, making banks, electronic-money institutions and microfinance institutions interoperable nationwide. The governor of the central bank put financial-account access at 4% in 2011 and about 36% in 2024, and named state payments and cross-border payments as the next phases. It was built in 127 days on Mojaloop open source by Guinéenne de Monétique, with AfricaNenda and Thitsa Works, expressly so that the state retains control of the infrastructure. The following day the central bank stated that more than 70% of payments are still made in cash even at merchants already equipped with electronic solutions, and named interoperable merchant QR codes and fiscal incentives as workstreams under study. Its project register records the RTGS migration to ISO 20022 held by unpaid invoices to the supplier CMA and customs clearance, and PAPSS participation with no transaction recorded.

The strategy that would order all of this is not yet written. The central bank advertised a four-month consultancy on 14 August to draft a National Payment Systems and Instruments Strategy for 2027 to 2030, with applications closing on the 31st. No text, budget or adoption date exists.

Kenya

Borrowers can repay Hustler Fund loans in loyalty points from 23 July, five points settling one shilling, recovering KSh 3m in the first week. A second operator launched a merchant wallet on 3 August.

Lesotho

The national e-invoicing platform went to nationwide rollout. Nationwide is the supplier's word: no taxpayer count, threshold, phase-in schedule or revenue-authority statement is held, so the base can record that the platform is being rolled out and not how far it has reached.

Liberia

The central bank's fee schedule for interoperable transfers was reported on 5 August: 1.0% of value from US$1.00 to US$2,000.00 and a flat US$25.00 above that, available 24 hours a day. The flat cap falls below 1.0% of value above about US$2,500 and keeps falling.

On 28 July the finance minister named the national electronic payment switch as the enabler of a 24-hour economy, with creative-sector support to enter the 2027 budget. No go-live date was given.

The central bank also put on record how the system was built. Its own account is that it worked to a business case rather than to a regulation and stood the system up in 73 days, sequencing government payments first - civil-servant salaries off cheques and into wallets, which gave the integrated mobile-money operators access to float, against a national target of half of adults holding a bank or wallet account.

Libya

Payments moved outward rather than inward. The central bank is reported to be planning accession to China's cross-border interbank payment system after talks with the People's Bank of China. The account is a foreign newspaper's: no Libyan statement, timetable or membership step is held, and nothing is said about what it would mean for settlement currency or correspondent banking.

Madagascar

On 3 August MVola's new director general gave the first account of the platform migration behind the outages of May and June. The core platform was replaced in May 2026; he states that money does not vanish from accounts, that reported cases have been regularised, and that the platform is stabilised with further work outstanding. No regulator is named, no incident report is published and no compensation is mentioned. Separately, Airtel Money integrated Baobab Bank into its mobile banking service on 17 July.

Malawi

On 25 July the central bank's expected banknote replacement cost for 2026 was reported at MWK 69.8bn against MWK 50.6bn in 2025, with an economists' association president naming government levies on digital money transfers as a reason cash use persists.

Two things moved in the regional rails above it. The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, with a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the corridor with Zambia, which gives the platform operational and governance rules it did not have. Separately a commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Malawi on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Malawi.

The same report gives the mobile-money platform its first published revenue line: MK51.93bn in 2025, up 77 per cent, on a stated base of more than 140,000 active agents.

Mozambique

Payments moved in two directions. The central bank set limits on payments abroad made with bank cards, revoking its December 2025 notice â€" a restriction on what a card can do rather than an extension of it. In the other direction a health agency reported cumulative disbursement of US$14.4m to health workers over mobile money for campaign payments, the largest use of the mobile-money rail for public payment the base holds here.

Namibia

The central bank, the instant payments company and the clearing house signed a declaration of intent on 2 July to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure, publishing no deliverables, funding or timetable (declaration account).

The payments association's annual general meeting on 28 July also heard that licensing and supervision of payment providers will move to the central bank, with no instrument, commencement date or transition plan published (central bank account).

The central bank governor put a date on the phone-based channel. He said on 27 August that a digital money and instant payment solution should be fully functional by about June 2027, sequenced government-to-person, then person-to-person and person-to-merchant, pitching it as a way to build transaction histories that substitute for the financial statements banks demand of informal businesses; how cash integrates with the instant payment system was not stated.

Niger

On 29 July the higher education minister said the grants agency reform consists of acquiring database software and routing scholarship and social-aid payments through the banking system via the Treasury's application; no budget, vendor, timetable or beneficiary count was published.

The mobile-money issuer opened cross-border corridors. It launched an international transfer service on 25 August, taking inbound transfers from eight countries directly into the recipient's wallet through five remittance partners and sending outbound transfers to seven West African states; no volume or fee schedule is published.

Nigeria

Payments produced real-time reporting of every licensed bureau's FX purchases from 15 July.

On 2 August an account of African corporate venture capital recorded that tier-one Nigerian banks hold payments infrastructure inside the group rather than at arm's length, and that the central bank has begun regulating fintech ownership as well as conduct. The base carries no earlier statement of the ownership position, so no change can be stated.

The central bank then set out what it wants that infrastructure to look like. A circular imposes market-structure caps of 25% on card issuing and 15% on acquiring, mandatory localisation of payment data by 1 January 2027, and disclosure of ultimate beneficial owners on banks, fintechs and payment service providers, against an estimated US$850m a year spent on offshore hosting and about 90% of Nigerian payment data currently held abroad. Those figures are the analysing firm's estimates and the circular text itself is not held.

Three admission gates opened alongside it. The central bank opened a second sandbox cohort to virtual-asset and data-enabled firms, applications running 12 to 31 August, and chairs a new Virtual Asset Council with the securities regulator and the revenue service, against an estimated US$92.1bn transacted in cryptocurrency by Nigerians between July 2024 and June 2025; the securities regulator admitted two further firms to its incubation programme, taking it to 12 since July. Neither publishes a graduation route or licensing outcome. The regulated naira stablecoin went live on a public blockchain on 12 August, with no supply, holder count or reserve attestation published.

Taxation moved in the other direction. Peer-to-peer and over-the-counter traders warned on 14 August that the 1.5% virtual-asset stamp duty and the taxes beside it could push activity into unregulated channels, the rules having been signed on 31 July. Separately the Lagos State revenue service is testing whether creator-economy platform payouts are royalties subject to 5% withholding tax, pressing two named platforms to deduct at source under the 2025 tax act — the same authority's earlier attempt to make a ride-hailing platform a collection agent being the precedent. No assessment, ruling or judgment is published in either matter.

Two structural changes to the acceptance side arrived in mid-August. A Nigerian payments company gained direct access to a global card network as a non-bank acquirer, letting it onboard licensed merchants for card acceptance without a bank sponsor; no merchant count, pricing or settlement arrangement is stated, and the base holds no central bank statement on non-bank acquiring. And the channel mix reversed: ATM transactions rose 6.6% year on year in the first quarter of 2026 with value up 64.6% to NGN26.3tn, while point-of-sale volumes fell 19.9% to 2.92bn, the agent-banking limits of October 2025 — single-provider terminals, a 70-metre radius rule and a NGN1.2m daily cap — constraining the agent channel as the central bank pushes bank ATM expansion. That is a policy effect rather than a preference shift, and no measure exists of what it did to access in places with no bank branch.

The virtual-asset track kept admitting. Three further firms were named as admitted to the securities regulator's incubation programme in the week to 17 August, and a separate account describes the state coordinating the central bank, the securities regulator, the tax authority and the financial-intelligence agency into a regulatory consortium for virtual assets rather than restricting the sector, pairing the incubation programme and revised digital-asset capital requirements of NGN2bn for exchanges and custodians with an August virtual-asset tax framework. The counts across accounts overlap and are not reconciled.

The rail underneath all of it began to change. The clearing operator reports 26.55 million transactions worth 1.4 trillion naira across 48 institutions in the early phase of the ISO 20022-compliant stack that replaces the instant-payments system, on a multi-currency platform carrying payments, identity and data together. The figures are the operator's own.

The withdrawn credit product came back on 24 August. The dominant operator resumed airtime lending on four vendors after the April suspension that followed new consumer-watchdog licensing and consumer-protection requirements, with its lending base cut to about a quarter of its first-quarter run rate and a stated cost of about 50 billion naira (US$37.1m) to first-half revenue. The group expects the whitelisted customer base to rebuild through the third and fourth quarters — its own forecast, and no regulator statement on the resumption is held. The jurisdictional question the suspension turned on is unresolved and before the Court of Appeal.

Rwanda

Effective 14 July the central bank designated one rail as the national instant payment system by directive, connecting 22 financial institutions bank to wallet to merchant in any direction, with a per-transaction ceiling. An interoperable bank-to-wallet transfer that could previously cost as much as RWF 5,000 now costs a flat RWF 20 regardless of amount, about one US cent on the publisher's own conversion. The directive itself is not held.

The layer the rail does not touch moved the other way. Regulator statistics for the first quarter of 2026, reported on 31 July, put the second operator's share of the mobile-money market at 14.3% against 16.9% a year earlier, and its active agents at 48,847 against 53,316 — a contraction in the cash-in and cash-out network on which rural households depend, over exactly the period interoperability was meant to help.

Sierra Leone

A re-platforming of the national payment rails — real-time gross settlement and automated clearing — is reported to have been contracted in early August, but no award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the procurement authority is published, and the aggregator listing that carried the figures is not an origin this base accepts. The award is not held, and no amount, supplier or scope is stated here on that basis.

The same 4 August ministerial statement disclosed about 390 Orange mobile-money fraud complaints logged in 2026 to date and more than 18,000 police requests for subscriber data answered.

South Africa

Operation Vulindlela's quarterly report of 31 July recorded the Payments Ecosystem Modernisation programme moving beyond conceptual design into active development of a payment credential, wallet, governance and trust capabilities, with testing against government use cases dated November 2026. Nothing held states how that rail relates to the bank-API rails below.

The Reserve Bank gazetted a national interoperable payment code standard, with PayShap the first rail to adopt it. Ozow launched a shared bank application-programming-interface rail with FNB and RMB, its fourth such arrangement, and Pepkor announced a R21.3bn merger of Flash and Shop2Shop, subject to approval.

What that migration costs the institutions running it surfaced in one bank's half-year results. Technology spending reached R8.78bn in the first half of 2026, up 7%, against digitally active customers up 14%, with a further R200m software impairment after a R2.4bn write-down in 2025, and a cost-to-income ratio still rising across a 17-country, 13.4-million-customer footprint. It is one bank's own group figure, so it bounds the cost of digital migration at a single institution rather than for the sector.

A second QR estate surfaced beside the bank-led standard. A proprietary scheme claimed more than 600,000 acceptance locations and more than 19 million inclusions across consumer banking, fintech and financial service provider applications, and was added to a handset maker's wallet on eligible devices. The figures are the scheme provider's own, carried in the handset maker's statement, and nothing on this ledger relates the scheme to the national payment code standard.

South Sudan

Financial technology gained a supporter rather than a system. Support for the sector was reported in August from a foreign government, with no value, instrument, recipient or programme document held. Separately the national payment system bill went through a five-day validation workshop in Juba and remains a bill.

Sudan

The Central Bank revoked the Al-Asjad payment-switch licence on 4 July 2026, days after the platform launched in Port Sudan with a Sovereignty Council representative present; no specific breach was disclosed, and unconfirmed press reports say the firm was incorporated only in late 2025 with a Dubai branch. The national payment switch launched live on 6 August, connecting Omdurman National Bank as first and only participant and completing a first ATM withdrawal over the switch; the Central Bank's own framing is restoration of war-damaged infrastructure, not a new rail, and no schedule for connecting further banks was given. Al Jazeera field reporting from Omdurman and Khalifa markets on 31 July found bank apps, chiefly Bankak, dominant in retail settlement, driven by cash scarcity and currency collapse rather than technology uptake, with recurring failure modes including no-smartphone workarounds, app outages and mistaken transfers.

Tanzania

The mandatory electronic payments order came into operation on 1 July 2026. It is an order under the electronic transactions Act rather than regulations, as widely mis-reported; it is prospective only, businesses taking cash at commencement have until 1 January 2027 to comply, and cash remains legal tender.

One month in, the price of using the rails became the argument. On 31 July the central bank capped bank-to-wallet interoperability at TZS 5,000 above TZS 500,000, single instant transactions and retail bank-to-bank transfers at TZS 2,000, and card payments at zero, removing intra-bank transfer charges and a Zanzibar card surcharge. The same day the governor rejected a general price cap demanded by users and analysts; one analyst put the worked cost at about TZS 3,500 per TZS 100,000 paid and argued that the mandate manufactures avoidance.

A technical meeting in Zanzibar from 7 to 11 July advanced the governance, commercial and risk frameworks for a cross-border instant-payment corridor with Rwanda. No launch date was set.

August supplied the adoption side of the same picture, from two directions. The government is promoting affordable-smartphone financing to widen electronic-payment take-up, with active mobile money accounts up 7.5% to 87.05 million and smartphone penetration at 44.74% in June 2026, as the central bank directs eight business sectors to adopt electronic payment systems within six months from January 2027. And in the countryside an operator's agricultural service pays crop proceeds straight to farmers' phones, reporting more than TSh150bn paid to farmers in two southern regions in the 2025/26 season and over TSh50bn already in 2026/27, covering more than 2,000 coffee and pigeon-pea farmers in two northern regions and expanding into the southern highlands, alongside linked credit and health insurance. Every figure is the operator's own, given at a promotional exhibition at which it also awarded vehicles and phones to loyal users, and no farmer total, fee schedule or default rate on the linked credit is published.

Acceptance widened from outside as well. A commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Tanzania on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Tanzania.

Zanzibar moved a fare box onto a wallet. Fares on the fifteen electric buses that entered commercial service on 1 August are paid by smart card through a single mobile-money platform at Sh700 a journey and Sh350 for students and passengers over 70, the same platform carrying municipal parking fees, traffic fines and state payments to clove farmers.

The state operator took its card into a stadium. On 30 August it and the Zanzibar Football Federation signed a sponsorship and partnership agreement to introduce e-ticketing for Zanzibar football through the operator's N-Card platform. No launch date, ticket volume or fee is stated, and the base holds nothing on the platform's other uses or acceptance footprint.

Togo

Payments moved on a deadline. Retirement allowances began paying by bank transfer and mobile money in July, and allowances stop on 31 August for beneficiaries who have not registered payment details; no beneficiary count or registration rate is published, and no alternative is stated for someone without a bank account, a handset or an identity document. The regional deadline to connect to the instant payment platform moved from 30 June to 30 September, and to 30 June 2027 for microfinance institutions. A treasury prepaid card was announced with no timetable and no confirmation that a file has been lodged with the central bank.

The month's other payments development is private and points outward. A domestic financial-technology firm founded in 2024 runs a single platform interconnecting bank transfers, mobile wallets and dollar stablecoins, converting into the naira, shilling, cedi and the CFA francs, and exposing payment operations to autonomous software agents. No transaction volume, corridor count, licence or customer figure is stated, and the account is a profile rather than a filing.

Tunisia

Tunisia's payments market is large enough for the question of who bears a loss to matter, and the law does not answer it. A published legal analysis finds no Tunisian text — not the 2000 electronic commerce law, the 2023 cybersecurity decree-law, nor the central bank's 2024 circular — allocating the loss between bank, merchant and cardholder when an electronic payment is hijacked, altered or blocked by a cyber incident, against 164.8 million transactions worth 29.5bn dinars in 2025, up 12.3%, and reported cyber incidents rising from 63,000 in 2021 to more than 155,000 in 2022. The absence is now recorded as a gap.

The month's other payments item was an outage notice rather than a policy: the interbank switch announced a planned technical intervention overnight on 11 August, which is the only public statement the base holds about the availability of the rail those 164.8 million transactions run on.

The founding instrument behind the online honour loans is now held: Decree 2026-148 of 23 July 2026, published in the official journal, fixes the conditions and criteria on which the micro-financings are granted - the text the base had been carrying only through a secondary account of its ceilings and grace period.

Uganda

Three payment arrangements were opened in the month, all private. A licensed local-currency-in, stablecoin-out settlement corridor across four East African markets including Uganda opened on 16 July with no volume or counterparty figure published. On 21 July motor third-party insurance went on sale over a mobile-money channel with a digital sticker issued online, framed by the insurance regulator as narrowing the protection gap; no premium, policy count or target was published. On 24 July a bank and a payments company signed a memorandum on school-fees saving with payment-history-based financing, agent-network healthcare payments and digitised insurance. The signature date is unestablished, and nothing is on file about consent, retention or the legal basis for the credit-scoring layer.

A fifth put fares on a network. An operator and an electric bus company launched a cashless route in Kira Municipality, combining electric mobility, connectivity and digital payments, attended by the ministers for science and technology and for Kampala; no fleet size, fare, ridership or payment instrument is published. It is the base's first instance of public-transport fare collection being digitised here.

A fourth opened a settlement route rather than a product: a commercial bank integrated China's cross-border interbank payment system to offer direct yuan settlement to Ugandan businesses, against imports from China of US$3.3bn in 2025 and exports of US$118m. One bank's service, with no volume, fee or central-bank position stated.

The scale underneath all of it is in the regulator's quarterly report: 2.55 billion mobile money transactions in the second quarter of 2026, up from 2.37 billion in the first, on 59.5 million registered subscriptions, with telecommunications revenue at UGX 1.73 trillion.

A fourth arrangement opened on 19 August, and it is card rather than wallet: a commercial bank and an international scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Uganda, settling in local currency, US dollars or both. The merchant count is given for the nine markets together.

A parliamentary committee found the expressway concession still running on cash. Its report of 25 August recommends that the revenue authority take over toll collection and introduce electronic payment, calls for a forensic audit of the concession's operations and revenue collections, and asks for scrutiny of a reported UGX 36 billion contract extension; the ICT minister of state told the House that the operator has never given government the source code or password of the system.

Zambia

On 27 July a vendor manager stated on the record that the National Financial Switch's intended reduction in customer transaction costs has not happened yet, that the central bank is only now focusing on it, and that the electronic clearing house is not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme (switch account).

Retail participation in the securities market is the one digital adoption figure the month produced: registered users of the exchange's mobile trading application rose to 51,791 in July from 49,611 in June. It is the exchange's own count of registered users, not of active traders or funded accounts.

The regional rail above the domestic one acquired its rules. The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, with a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the corridor with Malawi. No Zambian transaction volume, participant count or fee schedule is published.

Acceptance also widened from outside. A commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Zambia on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Zambia.

Zimbabwe

The road authority took handover of an expanded toll plaza on 29 July with two of six lanes reserved for radio-frequency tag holders, a second plaza due the next day and a third under construction, against a stated programme covering all 29 tollgates; the announcement states nothing on retention, access or legal basis for the movement record the tags generate (handover account).

The switch operator reported interoperable quick-response payments in rollout and participation in a pan-African settlement system, with no merchant, acceptance-point or transaction count (conference account).

The quarter's own numbers came from the central bank rather than from a conference platform. Its report for the quarter ending 30 June puts electronic transactions at ZiG757.12bn, up 23.71% on the first quarter, on 265.7 million transactions, with real-time gross settlement carrying 67.00% of the value and mobile money 12.96% of it on 236.67 million of the transactions — the same split the base has carried since the fourth quarter of 2025, of a system whose value moves through settlement and whose use is almost entirely mobile.

Acceptance also widened from outside. A commercial bank and an international card scheme opened online acceptance of that scheme's cards to participating merchants in nine African markets including Zimbabwe on 19 August, settling in local currency, US dollars or both; the merchant count is given for the nine markets together and not for Zimbabwe.

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

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